

STATE OF NORTH CAROLINA

COUNTY OF VANCE

The Vance County Board of Commissioners met in regular session on Monday, July 7, 2025 at 6:00 p.m. in the commissioners' conference room, Vance County Administration Building, 122 Young Street, Henderson, NC. Those commissioners present were as follows: Chair Carolyn Faines, Commissioners R. Dan Brummitt, Charisse Fain, Thomas S. Hester, Jr., Leo Kelly, Jr., and Valencia L. Perry.

Absent: Vice-Chair Yolanda J. Feimster.

Also present were County Manager C. Renee Perry, Assistant County Manager Jeremy Jones, Finance Director Stephanie Williams, County Attorney Jonathan S. Care, and Clerk to the Board Kelly H. Grissom.

Pastor Abidan Shah, Clearview Baptist Church, gave the invocation.

The first item on the agenda was the annual meeting of the ABC Composite Board consisting of the Board of Commissioners, the Chair of the Board of Education, and the Mayor of the City of Henderson. Board of Education Chair Dorothy Gooch and Mayor Melissa Elliott were absent. Dr. Roddy Drake and Ms. Anne Tucker had submitted letters seeking reappointment to the Vance County ABC Board for three-year terms. One application was received from Pam Hester requesting to be appointed.

Motion was made by Commissioner Thomas S. Hester, Jr. to reappoint Roddy Drake and Anne Tucker to the Vance County ABC Board for three-year terms. This motion was seconded by Commissioner R. Dan Brummitt and unanimously approved.

Public comments were heard next. Ms. Angie Ryan asked the board to implement the two fire studies that were performed years ago. She stated that the fire department should remain a full-time department, and the rescue squad should be managed under the fire department.

Mr. Steve Lyles stated that the rescue squad is a vital part of this county and should remain as is.

Mr. Arnold Pharr, Environmental Waste and Debris Removal, stated that he would like to partner with the county to combat the litter problem throughout the county as well as illegal dumping, storm debris, and overgrown vegetation.

Mr. Brandt Smith introduced himself as the president of SGS Contracting in Durham, NC. He stated that as local communities migrate to a more digital age, he offered his services to the county if needed.

Doctor K. Aal-Anubia, Magnetic Lighthouse Community and Economic Development Corporation, stated that one of his organization's goals is to build an economic eco system that enable companies to hit \$1 million in revenue. He stated that he is seeking a grant from the National Science Foundation Smart and Connected Communities and asked for a letter of support from the county. He stated that his vision is to make Vance County a model for smart city innovations by blending advanced technology with any of the county's future development.

Ms. Mary Susan Williams asked what can be done to enhance Vance County. What is being done to attract businesses and residents to the county? She stated that she is disappointed that the board did not reduce the tax rate and that more was not given to teachers.

Mr. Frankie Nobles, Vance County Employee Engagement Team Chair, appeared before the board to recognize the new employee of the month. He stated that the engagement team has developed a new procedure to follow when no employee has been nominated by their peers. The team will now look at employee longevity. When an employee has been identified, the department head will be contacted to ensure that employee meets the qualifications for the employee of the month.

This month's recognition goes to Captain Durwood Campbell with the Vance County Sheriff's Office. Sheriff Brame stated that Captain Campbell has been an exemplary employee and noted that he plans to retire at the end of this month with 28 years of service. Captain Campbell will receive a monetary gift and a designated parking space for the month. He was presented with a plaque, and the board congratulated him on receiving this recognition.

Sheriff Curtis Brame then appeared before the board and provided an update on detention center upgrades and repairs as follows:

- Population as of July 2 is 47
- Remainder of population is being housed throughout the state
- Eight new correctional officers have been employed with an additional five scheduled to begin in the next 20 days
- Supervision rounds were at 100% as of the week of June 16th
- Contraband has greatly diminished
- Comprehensive Plan of Correction submitted to state as scheduled
- Doors and food passages can be locked and secured
- Metal detector installed and operational
- General repairs and cleaning completed on showers, sinks, toilets, light fixtures, vents, ceiling tiles, ventilation units, fire system, painting, etc.

- Awaiting installation of new video system and repairs and upgrades to the command center stations.

Staff presented pictures to the board of damage that has occurred by inmates since these repairs have been made. This includes holes in walls and ceilings, two-way communication ripped out of the wall, lights damaged, and showers being pried from wall openings. The board questioned how this could happen if the detention officers are making proper rounds. Sheriff Brame stated that it is impossible to stop inmates from damaging property and blamed a lack of training of non-detention officers, and booth operators do not have direct line of sight. Commissioner R. Dan Brummitt stated that inmates should be charged for these damages.

Following further discussion, the board thanked Sheriff Brame for his report.

Mr. Todd Davis, Moseley Architects, and Mr. Blair Bordeaux, Bordeaux Construction appeared before the board to discuss the renovations of the current detention center facility, design and build of a new facility, and the construction contract. They also provided an assessment of the current facility and of most concern is the antiquated camera and intercom system. Other concerns include lack of supervision of inmates, improper lines of sight, and understaffing. Commissioner Thomas S. Hester, Jr. asked how far in advance a construction site needs to be identified for the new facility. Mr. Davis stated that six months should be adequate.

Following brief discussion, motion was made by Commissioner Thomas S. Hester, Jr. to approve the construction contract subject to county attorney and county manager review and appoint the county manager as the point of contact. This motion was seconded by Commissioner Leo Kelly, Jr. and unanimously approved.

Mr. Doyle Carpunky, Vance Rescue Squad, appeared before the board to discuss the rescue squad's contract. It was noted that during a previous meeting, the board discussed dissolving the rescue squad and merging it with the county fire department. It was also noted that the county could purchase needed equipment for approximately \$160,000. Mr. Carpunky stated that this is not possible and noted that the rescue squad's heavy rescue truck that was purchased in 2006 cost over \$309,000. He stated that Alamance County Rescue just purchased a similar truck for \$1.2 million. He also noted that the rescue squad and Watkins VFD are the only departments certified for heavy rescue. This does not include the City of Henderson. He opposes the rescue squad being consolidated with the county fire department.

Chair Carolyn Faines noted that the fire study recommends consolidation. Commissioner Thomas S. Hester, Jr. expressed his concerns with the amount of funding provided to the rescue

squad and supports consolidation. Commissioner R. Dan Brummitt expressed his concerns with consolidation and stated that the fire study says two different things. He stated that the fire study needs to go back to the public safety committee. He also stated that the county does not need to spend taxpayer dollars duplicating services, plus county personnel would need to be certified, which will take time and money.

Following discussion, this matter was referred back to the public safety committee and fire commission for further review.

Fire Chief Marvin Harrison appeared before the board and provided information on equipment acquisitions designed to enhance emergency response capabilities and foster stronger regional collaboration across the county and surrounding areas. He noted that the fire department is finalizing a memorandum of understanding (MOU) with neighboring fire and rescue agencies to enable integration of personnel and resources. This will lead to faster, more coordinated response times for missing person searches, dive operations, and technical rescues. The department is also investing in key equipment upgrades including two rescue boats, a utility task vehicle, and aerial and underwater drones. He noted that this equipment will be made available to all volunteer departments, not just the county department.

He reported that Engine 3 offers expanded compartment space to carry specialized equipment which will operate in conjunction with the newly developed Technical Rescue Team (TRT) utility trailer. Final equipment delivery is expected by the end of the month. He also informed the board of the planned formation of several specialized response teams including a dive team, a technical rescue team, a fire investigation team, a drone operations team, and a surface-water rescue team. In August, a training initiative in partnership with the community college and other local agencies will be launched. Personnel will engage in hands-on instruction and advanced scenario-based exercises to prepare for a full spectrum of emergency situations. He stated that a one-time capital investment of \$195,000 is fueling these equipment upgrades and team expansions.

Commissioner R. Dan Brummitt asked how long it would take for the fire department to become rescue certified. Mr. Harrison responded that it is possible to be certified in two months, depending on what is needed. This will be discussed further at the public safety committee meeting.

Water District Board

Chair Carolyn Faines called the Water District Board to order.

The May 2025 monthly operations report was presented to the board for information. Commissioner R. Dan Brummitt noted that water pressure was lost last week in the Kittrell area. He asked why a boil water advisory was not issued. Mr. John Greer with Envirolink responded that it was not issued because the pressure was lost at the tank, not in the line. He stated that as long as there is pressure in the line, there is no time for bacteria to grow which is why a boil water advisory would be issued. That did not happen, so an advisory was not needed.

Chair Carolyn Faines adjourned the Water District Board.

Finance Director's Report

Detention Center In-house Repair Costs. Finance Director Stephanie Williams informed the board that as of June 30, 2025, the county has disbursed \$121,015.91 to vendors performing state mandated repairs to the existing detention facility.

Detention Center Inmate Housing Costs. Ms. Williams reported that as of June 30, 2025, \$230,360 has been disbursed to seven surrounding counties that are housing inmates during the state mandated repairs.

Education Lottery Fund Applications. Ms. Williams noted that a joint application filed by the county commissioners and the board of education must be submitted to the state in order to draw down available North Carolina Education Lottery funds from the Public School Building Capital Fund. The school facilities are in need of repairs and renovations to existing facilities such as interior painting and roof replacements. The board of education approved the four applications at its June 27, 2025 meeting totaling \$1,610,000. Recommendation: Approve the applications to draw down lottery funds to be used for repairs and renovations of school facilities.

Motion was made by Commissioner R. Dan Brummitt, seconded by Commissioner Thomas S. Hester, Jr., vote unanimous, to approve the applications to draw down lottery funds to be used for repairs and renovations of school facilities.

Franklin-Vance-Warren Opportunity Request. Ms. Williams stated that FVW Opportunity has made a request to receive the contribution allotted to them in the FY 22-23 and FY 23-24 budget ordinances. The amount allotted to them each year was \$12,000, which brings this request to \$24,000.

Motion was made by Commissioner Thomas S. Hester, Jr., seconded by Commissioner Leo Kelly, Jr., vote unanimous, to approve the request in the amount of \$24,000.

Assistant County Manager's Report

Extension of Emergency Pay Policy. Assistant County Manager Jeremy Jones noted that on April 14, 2025, the county manager presented a proposed Emergency Pay Policy to the board aimed at addressing critical staffing shortages within the county's detention services. The policy would be implemented for an initial period of eight weeks and was designed to provide enhanced compensation for current eligible detention staff and deputy sheriffs. In this eight-week period, the county has spent approximately \$94,430 total for emergency pay. He stated that in order to continue to address staffing shortages, staff is requesting a 90-day extension. After which, county administration will evaluate critical staffing areas throughout that period to determine if further extensions are necessary. Recommendation: Approve the 90-day extension for the Emergency Pay Policy.

Motion was made by Commissioner Thomas S. Hester, Jr. to approve the 90-day extension for the Emergency Pay Policy. This motion was seconded by Commissioner Leo Kelly, Jr. and vote was ayes – five (5); noes – one (1), with the dissenting vote being cast by Commissioner Valencia L. Perry.

County Manager's Report

USDA Engagement – Detention Center Financing. County Manager C. Renee Perry reported that board approval is required to engage with the United States Department of Agriculture (USDA) to begin the application process for loan financing to support the construction of the new detention center for Vance County. The USDA Rural Development Loan Program offers a viable financing option with competitive interest rates and flexible terms specifically designed to support rural communities with essential infrastructure projects like ours. She requested board approval to:

1. Authorize staff to formally engage with the USDA to initiate the loan application process for the new detention center project.
2. Allow staff to gather the required documentation, assessments, and preliminary planning materials needed for submission.
3. Permit staff to bring back any related agreements, resolutions, or additional approvals for board review as the process moves forward.

Recommendation: Approve moving forward with the USDA application process which does not commit the county to any final financial obligation at this stage. It will, however, position

the county to be better prepared to secure favorable financing terms once final project planning is complete and approved.

Motion was made by Commissioner Thomas S. Hester, Jr. to approve moving forward with the USDA application process and approve items 1 – 3 as stated above. This motion was seconded by Commissioner Leo Kelly, Jr. and unanimously approved.

Reimbursement Resolution – Detention Center. Ms. Perry requested board approval of a resolution declaring the county’s official intent to reimburse itself for certain expenditures related to the detention center repairs and new construction project. In accordance with Section 1.150-2 of the Treasury Regulations, this declaration is required in order for the county to use future bond or note proceeds to reimburse project costs that have been or will be paid. The resolution allows the county to proceed with paying design and other preliminary costs for the current detention center repair project and new construction using county funds, with the reasonable expectation that these expenditures will be reimbursed once debt financing is secured. The maximum principal amount of debt anticipated for this project is \$10,000,000. She stated that board approval will ensure the county remains compliant with federal reimbursement regulations and has the flexibility to move this important project forward. Recommendation: Approve the reimbursement resolution allowing the county to proceed with paying design and other preliminary costs for the current detention repair center project and new construction using county funds, with the reasonable expectation that these expenditures will be reimbursed once debt financing is secured. The maximum principal reimbursement amount of debt anticipated for this project is \$10,000,000.

Motion was made by Commissioner Thomas S. Hester, Jr., seconded by Commissioner Charisse Fain, vote unanimous, to approve the following reimbursement resolution allowing the county to proceed with paying design and other preliminary costs for the current detention repair center project and new construction using county funds, with the reasonable expectation that these expenditures will be reimbursed once debt financing is secured. The maximum principal reimbursement amount of debt anticipated for this project is \$10,000,000.

**RESOLUTION OF THE COUNTY DECLARING ITS OFFICIAL INTENT
TO REIMBURSE EXPENDITURES UNDER UNITED STATES
DEPARTMENT OF TREASURY REGULATIONS**

BE IT RESOLVED, by the Board of Commissioners (the “Board”) of the County of Vance, North Carolina (the “County”) as follows:

Section 1. It is hereby found, determined and declared by the Board as follows:

- (a) Section 1.150-2 of the Treasury Regulations (the “Regulations”) prescribes specific procedures which will be applicable to certain bonds or notes issued by the County including, without limitation, a requirement that the County declare its official intent to reimburse certain expenditures with proceeds of debt to be incurred by the County prior to, or within sixty (60) days of, payment of the expenditures to be reimbursed.
- (b) This declaration of official intent is made pursuant to Section 1.150-2 of the Treasury Regulations to expressly declare the official intent of the County to reimburse itself from the proceeds of debt to be hereinafter incurred by the County for certain expenditures paid by the County on or after the date which is sixty (60) days prior to the date hereof.
- (c) The County desires to expend its own funds for the purpose of paying certain costs of the current detention center repairs (the “Project – Phase 1”), and new detention center construction (the “Project – Phase 2”), for which expenditures the County reasonably expects to reimburse itself from the proceeds of debt to be incurred by the County.
- (d) \$10,000,000 is the maximum principal amount of debt expected to be incurred for the purpose of paying the costs of (the “Project – Phase 1”), and \$50,000,000 (the “Project – Phase 2”), as specified in (c) above.

Adopted this 7th day of July, 2025.

Carolyn Faines (signed)
Carolyn Faines, Chair

ATTEST:

Kelly H. Grissom (signed)
Kelly H. Grissom, Clerk to the Board

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KARTS Resolution – ROAP Funding. Ms. Perry stated that at the June 2025 meeting, the board approved KARTS to become the applicant for ROAP funding effective July 1, 2025. The approval requires a resolution to be adopted by the board. Recommendation: Approve the attached resolution which allows KARTS to apply for and directly receive the ROAP funding effective July 1, 2025.

Motion was made by Commissioner Leo Kelly, Jr., seconded by Commissioner R. Dan Brummitt, vote unanimous, to approve the following resolution which allows KARTS to apply for and directly receive the ROAP funding effective July 1, 2025.

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RESOLUTION
by the
Vance County Board of Commissioners
for
Kerr Area Transportation, dba KARTS, to Apply for, Administer and Report on all Funding Associated with the North Carolina Department of Transportation’s Rural Operating Assistance Program (ROAP)

WHEREAS, Kerr Area Transportation Authority created pursuant to Article 25 of Chapter 160A of the North Carolina General Statutes, which serves the counties of Franklin, Granville, Vance and Warren; and

Motion was made by Commissioner Thomas S. Hester, Jr., seconded by Commissioner Charisse Fain, vote unanimous, to approve the following consent agenda items as presented: May 2025 Tax Refunds and Releases, departmental monthly reports, and the minutes of the June 3, 2025 Board of Equalization and Review, the June 16, 2025 budget work session, the June 17, 2025 Board of Equalization and Review, and the June 23, 2025 special called meeting.

TAX OFFICE REFUND AND RELEASE REPORT FOR MAY 2025

TAXPAYER NAME	TAX YR	REAL	PERSONAL	SOLID WASTE FEE	REASON
HANKS YVONNE B	2024	\$1,213.50	\$0.00	0	CORRECT VALUE
KNOWLES STEPHANIE	2024	\$0.00	\$12.91	125	PERS PROP BILLED
MORENO CIRO CRUZ	2024	\$0.00	\$4.91	0	PERS PROP BILLED
ABBOTT RICHARD THOMAS	2025	\$0.00	\$9.08	0	PERS PROP BILLED
		TOTAL	TOTAL		
		\$1,213.50	\$26.90		

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Appointments. The following appointments were presented to the board for consideration:

Airport Authority - one-year term

Reappoint Brian Boyd

Reannoint Valencia Perry

Library Board of Trustees – three-year term

Reannoint Sandy Cowan, Mary Austell, and George Blackburn

Commissioner R. Dan Brummitt noted that there is an opening on the Audit Committee

Motion was made by Commissioner R. Dan Brummitt, seconded by Commissioner Leo

Appointment of NCACC Voting Delegate and Alternate. Motion was made by

Motion was made by Commissioner Thomas S. Hester, Jr., seconded by Commissioner Leo Kelly, Jr., vote unanimous, to enter into closed session to discuss an attorney client privileged matter and property matters.

Upon return to open session, motion was made by Commissioner R. Dan Brummitt, seconded by Commissioner Thomas S. Hester, Jr., vote unanimous, to approve the minutes of the May 5, 2025 closed session.

Motion was made by Commissioner Thomas S. Hester, Jr. to authorize staff to enter into a contract for \$60,000 for the purchase of three contiguous tracts of land on Hwy 39 North (six acres) for the purpose of constructing an EMS substation. This motion was seconded by Commissioner Leo Kelly, Jr. and unanimously approved.

As there was no further business, at 9:00 p.m., motion was made by Commissioner Thomas S. Hester, Jr., seconded by Commissioner R. Dan Brummitt, vote unanimous, that the meeting be adjourned.

Approved and signed August 4, 2025.

Carolyn Faines (signed)
Carolyn Faines, Chair